

ACTIVITY 4

FULL ESCALATION SIMULATION

Student Questionnaire Template

Name of Learner: <u>Hans Werner A. Huyo</u>	Date: <u>September 15, 2026</u>
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GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

Read the scenario carefully. Complete all four tasks. Provide clear, concise, and technically appropriate answers. Use the spaces provided. If additional space is needed, attach a separate sheet and identify the task number.

SCENARIO: "OPERATION MANILA FOG"

Classification: TRAINING EXERCISE

06:45 AM	Automated SIEM rule fires — "AFTER_HOURS_PRIVILEGED_LOGIN". User: admin_backup. Time: 6:43 AM. Source IP: 103.75.190.44 (external). Domain: CORP-DC-01.
06:47 AM	EDR on CORP-DC-01 detects: net user /domain command executed. New user account "svc_update01" created. Group membership: Domain Admins.
06:50 AM	Firewall log: CORP-DC-01 → 103.75.190.44:443. Transfer: 2.1 GB outbound. Protocol: HTTPS. Duration: ongoing.
06:52 AM	You arrive at work. These three alerts are in your queue. No other analyst has touched them. What do you do?

TASK 1 — ALERT CLASSIFICATION AND ATT&CK MAPPING

Classify each alert, map the relevant MITRE ATT&CK technique(s), and determine the overall severity.

1. Alert 1 — 06:45 AM: Privileged account login outside normal business hours.

Classification: Suspicious privileged account activity
ATT&CK Technique(s): T1078.002 – Valid Accounts: Domain Accounts

2. Alert 2 — 06:47 AM: Rogue account creation.

Classification: Malicious account creation / privilege escalation
ATT&CK Technique(s): TT136.002 – Create Account: Domain Account

3. Alert 3 — 06:50 AM: Massive outbound data transfer.

Classification: Suspected data exfiltration
ATT&CK Technique(s): T1041 – Exfiltration Over C2 Channel

4. Overall Severity: CRITICAL

TASK 2 — IP INVESTIGATION

Investigate whether IP address **103.75.190.44** is malicious. Use VirusTotal, AbuseIPDB, and Shodan.

Investigation Findings:

VirusTotal said it is clean but I'm still quite suspicious with it especially the 2.1 GB outbound

Both AbuseIPDB and Shodan have the same general information

The IP address 103.75.190.44 belongs to the AS55720/Gigabit Hosting Sdn Bhn, and VPSMALAYSIA.COM.MY in Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia.

Shodan

Hostnames: bestlifeboxman.org

Domains: bestlifeboxman.org

Country: Malaysia

City: Kuala Lumpur

Organization: VPSMALAYSIA.COM.MY
ISP: Gigabit Hosting Sdn Bhd
ASN: AS55720
Operating System: Windows Server 2012 R2 (build 6.3.9600)

Shodan Open Port: 5986 (when I search it on google its give me information that the target device has Windows Remote Management (WinRM) over HTTPS enabled and exposed to the public internet

While the AbuseIPDB is the 103.75.190.44 has been reported 2 times. The most recent report is from 3 months ago.

Conclusion:

The IP should be treated as a malicious/suspicious indicator and blocked pending investigation. The combined evidence suggests possible compromise of the domain environment, unauthorized Domain Admin account creation, and potential data exfiltration.

TASK 3 — INCIDENT TICKET

Complete the incident ticket using the information available in the scenario and your investigation.

Ticket ID:	INC-2024-0915-001
Date and Time:	06:45 AM
Detected By:	Automated SIEM / EDR / Firewall Log
Affected Asset:	CORP-DC-01
Affected User:	admin_backup, svc_update01
IOCs Identified:	• 103.75.19-.44 • bestlifeboxman.org • svc_update01 • 2.1 GB outbound HTTPS transfer
Severity:	CRITICAL

ATT&CK Techniques:

- T1078.002 – Valid Accounts: Domain Accounts
- T1136.002 – Create Account: Domain Account
- T1098 – Account Manipulation
- T1041 – Exfiltration Over C2 Channel

Analyst Assessment:

The incident is assessed as a likely active compromise of the domain controller. An unusual privileged login was followed by creation of a new account and assignment to Domain Admins. The compromised system subsequently initiated a large outbound HTTPS transfer to suspicious external infrastructure. These events indicate possible privilege escalation, persistence, and data exfiltration.

Action Taken:

- Isolate CORP-DC-01 from the network while preserving forensic evidence.
- Disable and investigate admin_backup and svc_update01
- Remove unauthorized Domain Admin privileges
- Block 103.75.190.44
- Preserve relevant SIEM/EDR/firewall logs
- Investigate for additional compromised accounts and systems.

Escalate To:

Tier 2 SOC Analyst / Incident Response Team / Windows & Active Directory Security Team

TASK 4 — VERBAL SBAR ESCALATION

Prepare and deliver a verbal SBAR escalation to the Tier 2 SOC Analyst. Write your script below.

S — Situation: Briefly state the current critical incident.

This is a critical suspected Active Directory compromise involving CORP-DC-01. At 06:45, the privileged admin_backup account logged in outside normal business hours. At 06:47, a new account was created and placed in Domain Admins. At 06:50, CORP-DC-01 began transferring 2.1 GB of data over HTTPS to external IP 103.75.190.44

B — Background: State the relevant alerts, affected accounts, asset, and indicators.

The affected asset is the domain controller CORP-DC-01. The accounts involved are admin_backup and the newly created svc_update01. The external IP is associated with VPS/hosting infrastructure in Malaysia. The events occurred sequentially within approximately five minutes

A — Assessment: Explain your assessment of the threat and potential impact.

I assess this as a critical, potentially active compromise. The attacker may have obtained privileged credentials, established a new Domain Admin account for persistence, and may be exfiltrating sensitive data from the domain controller

R — Recommendation: State the immediate actions you need Tier 2 to perform.

I recommend that Tier 2 immediately isolate CORP-DC-01, disable the suspicious accounts, block the external IP, preserve forensic evidence, review authentication and Active Directory logs, and hunt for lateral movement and additional compromised systems. We should also determine what data was transferred during the 2.1-GB connection